

US-Iran Briefing — Special Edition: Houthi Missile Hits Riyadh Airport, October 10

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Terminal 3 takes a direct hit

- Terminal 3 at King Khalid International Airport took a direct hit Saturday ~14:00 local; the terminal was evacuated and "at least some injuries" were reported, per Saudi officials. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- Loud blast heard at Riyadh airport; eyewitnesses and briefed sources describe the explosion and smoke. Etihad and Qatar Airways cancelled flights into Monday. — [Reuters](#)

Casualties: multiple wounded, no confirmed deaths

- Multiple people wounded, partial evacuation of the terminal. Two eyewitnesses described people lying injured inside the airport; 12+ ambulances responded. No confirmed deaths for Saturday. (Context: deaths were reported in the Wednesday and Thursday airport attacks earlier this week.) — [CNN](#)

Riyadh's airport goes dark

- Saudi aviation authority GACA suspended operations at King Khalid International Airport after the attack caused injuries. No reopening timeline announced; the airport's own alert tells passengers to check status with airlines before heading there. — [CNN](#)
- Airlines cancelling more flights: Etihad and Qatar Airways into Monday; Kuwait Airways cited the closure; Lufthansa suspended through Oct 16; Air India through Oct 10. Riyadh-bound flights diverting to Dammam and Jeddah. — [Reuters](#)

The diversion picture — including our own data

- Riyadh-bound flights diverting to Dammam and Jeddah as airlines cancel more flights into and out of the Saudi capital. — [Reuters](#)

Escalation markers and open questions

- The Houthis have declared Saudi airspace a battlefield, warned airlines "for the last time," and declared oil facilities targets. Houthi leader Abdul Malik al-Houthi warned in an Oct 9 televised speech that the strikes on Saudi Arabia "have not stopped." — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- The Journal frames Saturday's strike as Iran-backed Houthis; no direct Houthi claim of responsibility for Saturday's attack has been published and verified as of Saturday evening local. (The Houthi spokesman claimed Thursday's ballistic strike on the airport.) — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- Canada, Germany and Ireland warned citizens over the airport attack, per the Journal's reporting. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- The UK called it a "serious incident" and advises against all but essential travel to Riyadh province among others; France and the US also issued advisories, with the US Embassy advising avoidance of the airport area. — [CNN](#)

Riyadh carries on: conferences proceed

- World Petroleum Congress (Sun–Thu) proceeds as planned; delegates told to consider a four-hour drive from Dammam; Italy's energy minister joins by video link instead of flying in. The FII investment conference (Oct 26–29) proceeds with promised "comprehensive security measures." — [Reuters](#)

Markets

- Markets were CLOSED when the missiles hit — nothing on the board prices in this strike; the first verdict comes Sunday evening. Friday settle: Brent \$104.72/bbl, WTI \$91.85/bbl (as of 2026-10-09). No new vetted readings for US diesel, UK natural gas, or VLCC day rates today; the dashboard holds last values. — [Reuters](#)
- ATEX Global analyst Nick Twidale (via Reuters, Oct 9): the big market question is whether the White House sticks to its word if attacks intensify; any sign of reconsidered military action could spike oil, with Gulf tanker traffic already under pressure. — [Reuters](#)
- No new vetted transit readings in the last 24 hours; the board holds last values for Hormuz transits, Hormuz crude flow, and Bab el-Mandeb transits. — [Reuters](#)

Sources: [Wall Street Journal](#) · [Reuters](#) · [CNN](#) · [Reuters](#) · [Reuters](#)

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